



TRAFFIC moves above the San Andreas and San Jacinto faults in the Cajon Pass in San Bernardino County. ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times

Ominous quiet on the San Andreas

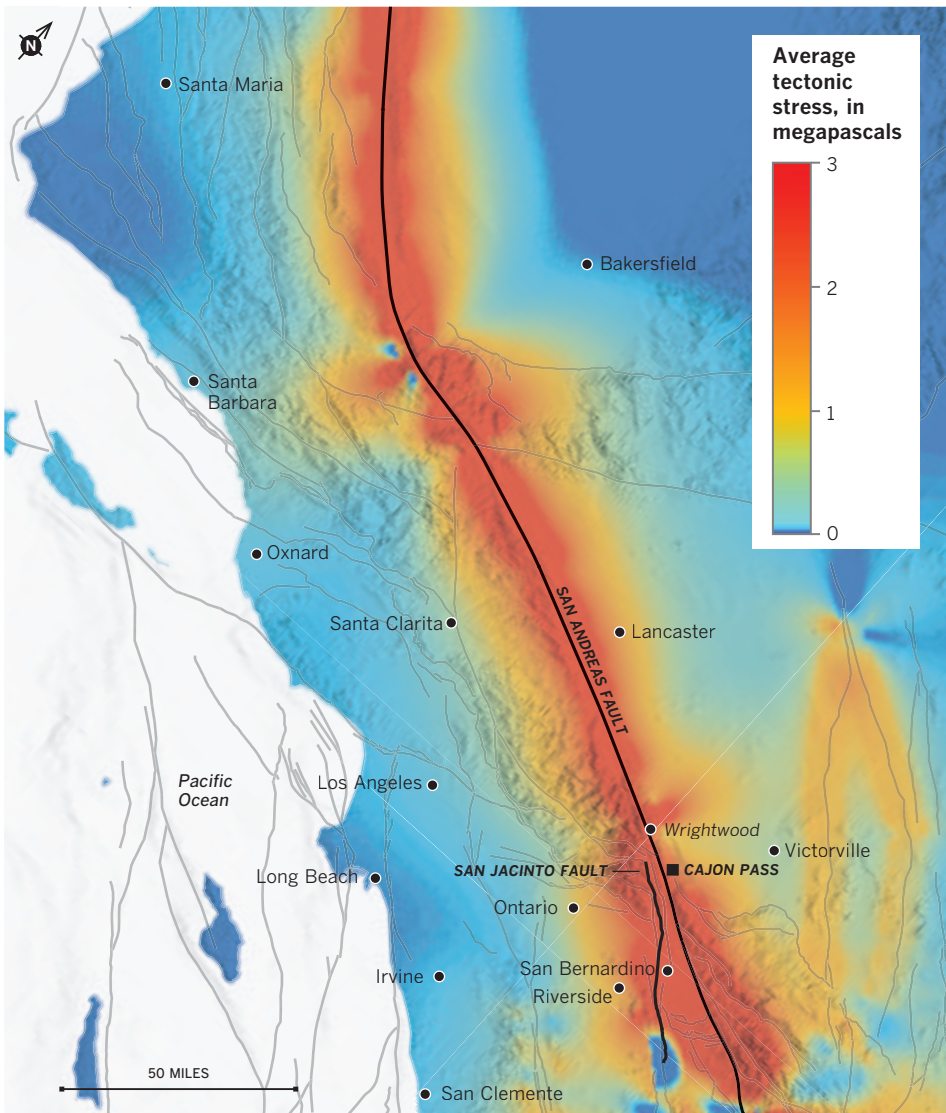
‘Mother of all faults’ has been silent for decades. Scientists fear it may soon snap.

By RONG-GONG LIN II

It lurks ominously beneath California’s many natural wonders, a reminder that nothing in this landscape is truly permanent. It’s been described as “the mother of all earthquake faults,” the source of both our geological birth and, perhaps, our ultimate undoing. But the most unnerving thing about the San Andreas fault these days may be its silence. It’s a mystery scientists are still trying to unlock. The San Andreas is central to any discussion of California. It’s the massive 800-mile spine of the state, trundling up the Coachella Valley to the San Gabriel Mountains, and pushing along the edge of Silicon Valley to beyond the Golden Gate. There is no simple answer for why California’s longest fault, responsible for some of America’s most powerful earthquakes, has produced so few in the last century. But it is clear that the quiet period is only increasing strain on the San Andreas, as well as on the state’s second-longest fault, the San Jacinto. A new study underscores the concern. Researchers estimated that key sections of the fault in Southern California

A red-hot San Andreas

Tectonic stress on these sections of the San Andreas and San Jacinto faults is high — shown in red — a consequence of more than a century without producing significant quakes. At the Cajon Pass, sections of the faults are at their highest strain in 1,000 years, calculations suggest.



Liliane Burkhard / University of Bern / University of Hawai’i at Manoa; Statewide California Earthquake Center Community Fault Model SEAN GREENE Los Angeles Times

Bill to curb ‘ghost guns’ draws ire of prop shops

By GAVIN J. QUINTON

California has some of the nation’s toughest gun laws, but state lawmakers are concerned that a new technology is allowing criminals to obtain firearms by building them from scratch. By using 3-D printers, they warn, lawbreakers are able to make key components of untraceable “ghost guns” with the press of a button. Ghost guns, which authorities say make it more difficult to investigate shootings because they lack serial numbers, have been a growing problem for law enforcement nationwide. According to federal data, the number of privately made firearms recovered in crimes surged from more than 1,600 in 2017 to nearly 27,500 in 2023. California leads the nation in recoveries over that period. In response, legislators

Affordable refuge is vanishing

The small patch of dirt encircling Carmen Silverio Guardado’s home bears fruit — lots of it. There are pomegranates, guavas, dragon fruit and nectarines. She also grows oregano and lemongrass, which she brews into a tea to soothe stomach issues. All of this Silverio Guardado and her husband cultivate beside the two-bedroom mobile home they have owned for 12 years. They have no plans to move — mostly because they could not afford to live anywhere else. Mobile homes are the cheapest form of housing in California. On average, owners spend about \$1,200 a month on housing, hundreds of dollars less than apartment renters and traditional homeowners, according to U.S. Census Bureau data. But in a housing crisis where the working solution is to build, build, build, some of the area’s least expensive housing has been steadily dismantled over the decades. Since 1986, according to data from the state hous-

Residents fight to remain in their mobile homes as park owners hunt greater profits from new uses

By AUDREY MCGLINCHY



VICTORIA RETA tends her plants at a mobile home park in Bell that the city intends to shut down. GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

A ‘complete 180’ on DOJ’s civil rights mission

California is the main target as a U.S. agency formed to counter inequality is recast.

By BEN WIEDER

WASHINGTON — The U.S. Department of Justice civil rights division was created in 1957 with an initial focus on combating racial inequality and protecting voting rights. But in the first two years of President Trump’s second term, its mission has been reimagined. Now, the division is focused on combating diversity initiatives, rolling back pro-transgender policies and rooting out allegations of election fraud. It had for decades investigated police departments for using excessive force. Now it investigates police departments with excessive delays in approving gun per-

mits. California has served as the division’s laboratory for all of these changes, or, as one former civil rights staffer put it, its “punching bag.” The civil rights division has been involved in twice as many cases in California as in any other state, according to a Times analysis of cases brought by the Justice Department. And an examination of press statements by the civil rights division shows that California has accounted for a higher proportion of actions in the second Trump administration than during the same time period in the Biden administration. The division is led by Harmet Dhillon, a Californian and a conservative legal crusader, who made her name bringing legal challenges against many of the state’s institutions and once served as the chair of the San Francisco Republican Party. [See DOJ, A8]

Iran attack kills at least 2 U.S. troops

American military responds after Tehran strikes base in Jordan, leaving one missing.

By JON GAMBRELL, TOQA EZZIDIN AND KONSTANTIN TOROPIN

DUBAI — The U.S. military on Saturday announced its first troop deaths from direct Iranian fire since the opening days of the war, with two killed and another missing in an attack on a base in Jordan after days of intensifying exchanges of fire. Friday’s drone and missile attack sent four other service members to hospitals, the military said. The dead were not identified. Since the war began, 16 U.S.

service members have been killed and more than 430 wounded. Hours after the announcement, the U.S. military said that it had launched new airstrikes against Iran to “swiftly punish” its paramilitary Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps for the deaths of the American troops. U.S. Central Command said the strikes were designed to further degrade Iran’s ability to restrict the traffic of oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz. Earlier Saturday, Iran’s supreme leader had warned of “unforgettable lessons” if the United States keeps attacking the Islamic Republic. The remarks read out on state TV and attributed to Mojtaba Khamenei, still unseen since the war began. [See Iran, A4]

Wildfires in Sierra unearth a tribal history

By NOAH HAGGERTY

CONCOW, Calif. — Until recently, when members of the Konkow Valley Band of Maidu pulled up a map of their ancestral land in the foothills of the Sierra Nevada, only about two dozen of their historic sites appeared. Disease, violence and forced labor had separated California tribe members from their history. Without routine Indigenous fire to clear out the foothills, the landscape — much of it now managed by the U.S. Forest Service — grew dense with conifers, obscuring the signs of their enduring presence.

As a result, archaeologists’ picture of the tribe’s past was spare. No more than 500 people. Going back about 3,000 years — a fraction of the time other tribes are known to have lived in the state. Then the forests burned. In less than a decade, wildfires destroyed forests across 95% of the tribe’s homelands. The Forest Service turned to the tribe for help healing the land. As members walked the wide-open moonscape, they found evidence of their vibrant history everywhere. Now just a few years later, their map shows more than 1,200 sites. [See Tribe, A9]

Nobel-winning chemist dies

Rudolph Marcus, Caltech scientist who studied molecules and energy, was 102. PERSPECTIVES, A2

Officer accused of past violence

ICE agent in fatal Maine shooting should never have had gun, his family says. NATION, A11

Forest workers taken hostage

Officials arrest father and son after standoff, rescuing employees. CALIFORNIA, B1

Weather Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 87/67. B8

